

Viral Infections

The first computer virus, the Elk Cloner, was written by Rich Skrenta, a 15-year-old high school student, in 1982. It targeted the Apple II OS as a boot sector virus. When a computer booted from an infected virus, a copy of the virus was placed in the computer's boot memory. When an uninfected floppy was inserted into this computer, it would get infected with the Elk Cloner. This one was benign: on every fiftieth boot of the computer, it would display a short poem:

Elk Cloner: The program with a personality

It will get on all your disks
It will infiltrate your chips
Yes it's Cloner!

It will stick to you like glue
It will modify RAM too
Send in the Cloner!

Twenty-five years later, today, Skrenta calls it a dumb practical joke.

WordPerfect concentrated too much on DOS, and when it finally released a Windows-compatible version, Microsoft Word had reached version 2.0.

The keyboard shortcuts its customers were so used to had to be different on the Windows platform, since the function keys had a different role. The printer drivers available with the DOS version were rendered obsolete on Windows. Due to these factors and Microsoft's aggressive marketing of its Office Suite, WordPerfect declined in popularity with sales grinding to a trickle.

Word does still have help for WordPerfect users, though!) Corel Corporation later bought over WordPerfect in order to get into the video editing market; WordPerfect was working on such a project.